



Tom Clancy passes away

On October 1st, spy thriller author Tom Clancy, passed away at the age of 66.
<http://dgit.in/16yLjH>

Self-assembling robots

This bunch of small brightly coloured magnetic cubes can spin, somersault and snap together to create all kinds of modular shapes. <http://dgit.in/1flbDdW>

LETTER OF THE MONTH

☑ Dear Team Digit, first and foremost, hats off to the entire team for improving the delivery service to subscribers and bringing it up to blazing speed. Whether India gets 5G or not in the near future, you guys definitely provide 10G in terms of speed of delivery. I remember some few years back there were delays, especially with the Special edition. But you guys have improved in this area, which is quite a milestone in itself. I'm quite sure the delivery guy has special connections with Rajnikant ;)

Keep up the good work.
 Coming to the issue, the editorial is just awe-inspiring and very close to my way of thinking.

The way Siddharth has written the editorial, I won't be surprised when he becomes a regular part of the editorial team. The complete layout of the magazine and the passion of each team member is evident in every single word.

It's evident from each of your issues that you guys sweat it out to be the best in the world and wave your magic wand on readers each time. The advertisements in the magazine are also well balanced, neither too much nor too less, which is quite a feat by itself. I just love the World View section from Day One of its origin. Please keep it alive for a decade or so :P

Just a few suggestions from my side:

- 1) How about interviewing inspirational and motivational personalities and ask them about their use of technology for maximum output and similar stuff.
- 2) Include a game or movie poster in some of the issue (as many readers have already demanded). It can be sponsored and another source of revenue for the magazine.
- 3) Kindly do a Fast Track on Troubleshooting your Smart Gadgets 3.0. (mobile, tablet, laptops, etc.)

PS: In case you're wondering who this fan boy of Digit is, I'm a Software Engineer with an athletic physique and buddies call me Abhishek Bachhan.

—Abhishek Kapoor



☑ TMI on the physical attributes but hey, nice to have you on board! Thanks for all the kind words and those three suggestions you've given are bang on. We'd like to implement each one of them and we're already working on them. With readers like you for support another decade should be a piece of cake. Do keep writing in and enjoy the t-shirt you get for letter of the month. Hopefully your athletic physique will make it a perfect fit :-)

—Siddharth

Up This Issue". It should be "36,000 Reasons..." This is because if a person who's really passionate about technology goes through a specification, he'll also find the related and fundamental ideas about that product or technology, and that's why the Oct 2013 issue was done perfectly. It also discredits salesmen and companies' strategies to fool their desperate customers who hide most naturally occurring factors in daily life.

Although a day before reading the magazine I bought a new smartphone, the reviews of smartphones are always pleasing. It's always interesting

to know what Team Digit thinks about the products and its practical factors from the users' point of view. The editorial about biased customers is enlightening and the advice helps buyers think before they act. I always support trying new products, no matters what the company profile.

Although I believe in the phrase "Silence matters more than words" and it took me about 7-8 years of being a regular reader of Digit since I was in 9th standard, this is my first response to you as I couldn't hold back any more.

—Gyanendra Tiwari

☑ Thanks for your kind words Gyanendra. You've managed to put smiles on all our faces. Just don't wait another eight years to write to us next time :-)

—Siddharth

I've been reading this mag for four years now (not regularly though) and this is my first letter to you. Firstly, I'd like to thank you for your fabulous work. I've learnt many things from your issues but it's the Fast Tracks that I enjoy the most. The reason I mentioned that I'm not a regular reader is because I pick up the issue based on the FastTrack content.

I have a few more things to ask of my favourite magazine. Why don't you provide TED videos regularly? Why don't you provide open-ware courses? Please provide an FT on advanced programming (not basic data structure like those available in most advanced programming books), it will be much appreciated.

Please add a devworx on software design using a combination of languages. I downloaded the source code of a few open source software the other day and it had some C files, some Flash and some XML. How did they all work together?

Also, provide a column on migrating from Windows 7 to 8 with reasons as to why many features that worked fine on Windows 7 have problems with Windows 8 (like creating ad-hoc networks, installing Visual Studio 2008, .Net before 4.0 etc.) Finally, change the UI of your DVD (the previous one with a Start menu was more interesting than the present one. Do you have a name for that?) and please add a PDF mentioning the list of software and resources available in the particular DVD (like many have said before). Thank you for your work and don't you ever dare stop publishing this magazine!

—Amrutansu Garanaik

☑ Thanks for the mail. We're glad that you're really enjoying the content we work so hard to create. Thank you. Digit is ever evolving and your suggestions are interesting. Don't be surprised if you start seeing some of your suggestions being implemented over the coming months. Do write to us again.

—Anirudh